

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruniravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills

Mogappair resident on a mission

Rapido bike taxi operator 'Karate' Mahalakshmi gets back home in the wee hours to ensure other women have a safe ride home late in the night



Mahalakshmi has worked with various schools as a karate instructor including the Velammal Group of Institutions. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

LIFFY THOMAS

Women wary of travelling at night with a male driver has someone to turn to: Rapido 'Captain' from Chennai, 45-year-old Mahalakshmi Ramalingam. She offers bike rides on Rapido late in the night. She is known as 'Karate Mahalakshmi' for a reason: she has been teaching and practising karate for two decades.

"From 9 p.m. to 1 a.m. my bookings are reserved for women, especially those returning from a long-distance

trip alighting at Koyambedu bus terminus or Perambur railway station and unable to get a bus," says the resident of Mogappair who has been with the ride-hailing app for the last two years.

Prior to that, Mahalakshmi had worked as assistant karate instructor with various schools including Velammal Group of Schools, Chennai Public School and Queen Mary's College, where she is often greeted by students who appreciate her influence as a trainer.

Her journey into martial art training began when she was 19, her mother enrolling her in a karate class in the

neighbourhood for self-defence. "I lost my father when I was 17 and that protective feeling was missing at home. I was overweight for my age with thyroid-related complaints, and people made fun of me," says Mahalakshmi.

Although karate empowered and boosted her confidence, she faced many hardships at home and in the workplace.

A school dropout, Mahalakshmi had to work to support her family, being the eldest child. She started by taking up odd jobs. Working as a karate instructor did not address the financial crunch.

"During April and May, we would not get any salaries as schools were not having classes," she says. Later, through a friend she got to know about Rapido. Mahalakshmi says the job has its challenges but on the upside, it offers flexibility.

"I have done close to 6,000 rides with both male and female riders. In some situations you have to be tough and certain others, it is better to ignore the taunts," says the captain who takes 10-15 rides a day.

Genuine expressions of thankfulness from women she had safely dropped at night serve as a motivation factor for Mahalakshmi.

A fellow journalist with *The Hindu* has been a regular rider with Mahalakshmi. She has ferried her many a time for a column featuring Chennai's night life.

Mahalakshmi's first love remains karate and she wants to impart self-defence training to women at Rapido so that they can take late night rides.

In her view, driving and martial arts are indispensable skills for every woman. Mahalakshmi is being helped by well wishers to fulfil her dream of establishing a self-defence and karate academy for women and girls.

'Sewage overflow is recurrent in Gandhi Street'

L. KANTHIMATHI



A recent instance of sewage overflow in Pattabiram. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Sewage overflow is a recurrent issue at Gandhi Street off CTH Road in Pattabiram in Avadi Corporation, causing Tamil Nadu Progressive Consumer Centre to reiterate its demand for an underground drainage network, not just in Gandhi Street but across Avadi Corporation limits. T. Sadagopan, president of this citizens forum, observes: "In many areas, sewage is let into open channels meant for stormwater; sewage overflow is witnessed around the Avadi bus terminus and in Thirumullaivoyal as well. In Gandhi Street, as parts of the stormwater channel were damaged on account of a road overbridge construction on CTH Road in Pattabiram, sewage flows on the road," he notes, seeking restoration of this stormwater channel and creation of an UGD network. Obviously, sewage cannot be let into stormwater drains.

"Officials cite widening of CTH Road for delay in providing underground sewage drains. One cannot buy into that as CTH Road widening is also not making progress, the project is still in land acquisition stage," says Sadagopan. "Avadi Corporation should address the stormwater channel issue by coordinating with the State Highways which is constructing the overbridge."



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‘East Balaji Nagar lacks proper roads’



T.R. ILAYAKUMAR

The interior lanes at East Balaji Nagar at Kallikuppam in Ambattur do not have proper roads. Most of them are earthen and uneven and therefore give room for waterlogging. This has been the status ever since the neighbourhood was formed in 1983.

The colony got its first road in 2014 and the next road the following year after several representations were made to the elected representatives and officials.

Further, the name boards of the streets, installed by the Greater

Chennai Corporation, are faded. And, some lanes lack name boards which makes it difficult for people who are new to the area find an exact location at East Balaji Nagar.

Yet another issue is that most of the roads of East Balaji Nagar are not listed in the Greater Chennai Corporation's portal. Residents while trying to register a complaint in the portal are forced to select nearby or incorrect street names and later explain the exact location through phone calls.

T.R. Ilayakumar is the president of East Balaji Nagar People Welfare Association



Some of the roads at East Balaji Nagar in Ambattur on June 18, 2026.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



A footpath in Agaram. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Footpaths usurped in Agaram’

ANOSH NISHTER SADAT

SRP Koil Street - North and SRP Koil Street - South in Agaram at Thiru Vi Ka Nagar in Perambur are busy roads and known for heavy traffic congestion. But pedestrian safety is compromised on these roads. The footpaths here are as good as non-existent. They are misused as a vehicular parking lot. This includes four-wheelers also. Further, hawkers and shopkeepers have occupied the pedestrian facility.

Eateries have kept tables for customers; a clothes shop has placed a hanging pole to display its collection of frocks; and a mechanic shop meant for cycles misuse the pedestrian space as its garage. In other



words, the footpaths are out of bounds for pedestrians. They are at the risk of being hit by vehicles.

The road margins are also en-

croached and this hinders a hassle-free flow of vehicles.

Anosh Nishter Sadat is a resident of Perambur

‘Dilapidated building is infested with snakes; complaints to GCC did not help’



The building on Second Street at North Jaganathan Nagar Annex in Villivakkam. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

LILIYAN SWARNA KALAI

An unoccupied building in Second Street at North Jaganathan Nagar Annex in Villivakkam is dilapidated and overrun with vegetation. The unkempt premises has become a conducive environment for all kinds of reptiles, especially snakes. It may be noted there has been an instance of snake bite here.

This premises poses a safety hazard to the public, especially for residents living near by. Therefore, several representations were made to Zone 8 officials of the Greater Chennai Corporation. But they were to no avail.

Liliyan Swarna Kalai is a resident of Villivakkam

‘Relay milled Raji Street soon’



Raji Street in Aynavaram. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

SINDHU SAPNA

Raji Street in Aynavaram, especially the stretch near Chennai Metrowater Training Centre, makes motoring challenging on account of its milled surface. It poses a risk to motorcyclists. The road has to be relaid without any delay.

Sindhu Sapna S. K. is a resident of Aynavaram

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No shelter from the sun for these bus commuters



Commuters stand exposed to the elements due to the lack of a shelter at Podi Kadai bus stop on Arunachalam Road in Chintadripet. PHOTO: VELANKANNI RAJ B

Rectify malfunctioning escalator at Egmore railway station



PHOTO: DHIVYA SARAVANAN.

DHIVYA SARAVANAN

Passengers at Chennai Egmore railway station are facing difficulties due to an escalator that frequently stops working. During the intense summer heat, senior citizens, women, children, and passengers carrying heavy luggage struggling the most on account of this glitch. Passengers notes the escalator works only at certain times and suddenly stops after a while. In many instances, it remains completely non-functional, forcing people to take the stairs instead. Many commuters said they expect basic passenger amenities at a major railway station to be maintained properly. They requested railway officials to monitor the escalator regularly and take prompt action whenever faults occur.

Preparing students for a future-ready workforce

The Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science (HITS), Padur, in collaboration with the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) and Ethnotech Academy, will soon launch a future skills centre to train students in emerging technologies.

The Hindustan Center for Future Skills will prepare students for careers in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Data Science and Analytics, Cloud Computing, Cyber Security,

Industrial Automation and Robotics, AR/VR and Metaverse Technologies, IoT and Smart Systems, Digital Marketing and Project Management.

The centre is being established to bridge the gap between academic education and rapidly evolving industry requirements by providing students with practical training, live industry projects, internships, and experiential learning opportunities.

Through collaborations with

leading technology companies - IBM, Apple, AWS, Microsoft, Cisco, Intel, Schneider Electric, Autodesk, Adobe, Meta, PMI, Pearson, Tally, and MathWorks- the center will provide globally relevant learning experiences and industry-recognized credentials.

Non-HITS students can enrol with a minimum +2 qualification.

For details, call M. Murali Krishna (Academics) at 9989086120; for admissions, call 8668093935.

Montessori educators receive directorship award



Hema Sridharan and Priya Grace Christabell (below) receiving the citation from Uma Shanker and Shalini Gopalakrishna, president and treasurer respectively of the Indian Montessori Center - Bengaluru. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Hema Sridharan and Priya Grace Christabell, faculty with Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC) - Chennai, were recently conferred with the 'Independent Directorship Award'.

The directorship is awarded to educators after a rigorous process that includes the submission of theoretical papers and practical training experience, both of which extends for over a few years.

The citations were presented by Uma Shanker, president, and Shalini Gopalakrishna, treasurer of the Indian Montessori Center (IMC),

Bengaluru.

An IMC-certified director of training courses can set up a teacher training centre, which is an important milestone in further spreading Montessori education in Tamil Nadu, a release stated.

The first teacher training centre in Tamil Nadu was set up in 1998 by Uma Shanker. Till date, over 150 teachers employed in Greater Chennai Corporation schools have undergone the Montessori teacher training conducted by IMTC-Chennai and Kalvi Trust for Research and Education, the release added.

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Crooners beat commuting blues on Chennai's suburban trains

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN



A Methuselah among train singing groups

Every day, at set hours in the morning and evening, a compartment in the local electric train on the Chennai Central-Tiruvallur suburban line morphs into a concert hall. Listening in to the voices from this decades-old amateur train singing group

On the 7.30 a.m. local from Tiruvallur to Chennai Central, compartment three (third from the motorman's cab) doubles as a jukebox. A one-off model, this jukebox cranks out live singing performances. First-timers are usually gobsmacked to hear vocal notes drowning the whir and whine of the suburban electric train and rising in cadence over the occasional clatter of its wheels. No professional singers in sight; nor trained musicians. And the singing can sometimes get ragged around the edges. Commuters are the voices, untrained, occasionally coarse-textured, but irresistibly real.

It is a group forged on the commute. People drawn from different walks of life, different offices, staying together on the commute because they have been singing together as the train carries them to work and home again. It is an "encore" on the 6.25 p.m. local from Chennai Central

to Tiruvallur, the group flexing their vocal cords again. This is a motivational reminder that between deadlines at work and chores at home, there is always a seat of relaxation to nestle into.

This "commuters choir" is as loosely defined as its daily playlist (Tamil and occasionally Hindi songs) and its roster of singers. As in any word-of-mouth tradition, there are multiple strands to its identity and history. Singers would reel off a diversity of names for the group. Some have given it a moniker, "Rail Ragam". Others hold on to a more idealised vision of it, choosing to keep it nameless, thereby deepening mystique. I. Jayaseelan, an advocate and a key member of the group, has an origin story for the group that melds with cosmogony upholding Big Bang Theory. "Nobody started it; the group was born suddenly. Nobody knows how," observes Jayaseelan. P. Venugopal, who joined the group in 2003 and contributes to the music

on the move with banjos, takes a "creationist" view, pointing out that a railway employee started it, and the young group was dandled and nourished by a diversity of commuters. Points of agreement include the group's longevity, close to 40 years old. Composition of the group: staff from Government Hospital, Secretariat, LIC, Harbour, law professionals associated with the High Court and from many private enterprises as well. There is no formal membership. People hop on and off the way they would a train.

However, to be able to hold court in a crowded compartment, a voice accustomed to the scrutiny of an audience helps. Those who sing invariably are given to the habit of singing in challenging settings. Jayaseelan reveals that he has a music troupe called "Inisai Saral". Music instruments such as rhythm pads are brought in by members. Even the sides of a compartment are used as surface for drumming.

The singers on the Chennai Central- Tiruvallur suburban line

On the commute, the singers are known to be offered small gifts, usually eats, if a listener is moved by the singing. "The best gifts are not materialistic; they come as appreciation which we accept with both hands," points out Jayaseelan. "Often, listeners get so lost in the music that they miss their destination, overshooting it by a few stations. Sometimes, they deliberately miss their destination to listen in to more songs."

A train compartment is a shared space, and some commuters might want the sanctity of such spaces to be protected, along with their peace. And that would mean hey do not sign up for the impromptu concert.

"Sometimes, the singers might get carried away, and get too loud for the non-participants' comfort. There have been instances where a singer has been 'led away' by the railway police. Not arrested, just led away," says Jayaseelan.

The advocate notes "the singing will not die down; and the phenomenon is hardly unique to the Chennai Central to Tiruvallur local. There is a long-lasting singing group on the Chennai Beach to Tambaram suburban line; and another on the Chennai Beach to Tiruvallur line."

What is more delectable than the singing in these train groups is the notes of camaraderie and relaxation that are struck silently. Strangers become companions. Weary commuters find solace. An old soul feels renewed, breathing in the air of nostalgia.

For details about the group, call 94441 07353



This unit changed tracks

From devotional to film songs, Pallavaram Return to Tambaram Local, this train commuters music group has experienced notable shifts but is still 'singing' strong

Suburban train singing groups rarely change tracks. Almost everything, from the timings and compartment to the route and genre, is "notated" with indelible ink. And the settings and processes continue without a semitone of variation. The singing group on the Tambaram to Chennai Beach suburban line strayed off this predictable course.

First up, the route. Around 30 years ago, the group whirled into soundscape on the Pallavaram Return, a service originating at Pallavaram station at 9.30 a.m. and screeching to a halt at Chennai Beach. Om Balachandran, employed as public relations inspector at the Anna Salai post office, is by his own admission, a member of this group not by the strength of his vocal cords, but his cochlea. He can sound Descartian if he chose to: "I listen, therefore I am (a member of this group)." And this is what Balachandran "the listener" has to say: the route changed around the pandemic when "Pallavaram Return" service was waved into retirement. Since then the group is associated with the 8.50 a.m. Tambaram local. The "mobile concert hall" is the third compartment from the guard van.

"Still, a majority of the members are from Pallavaram and Chromepet," Balachandran emphasises. The group has had another notable shift: from hymns to hits. In its early days, devotional songs were its staple. And then filmy earworms (Ta-



The group in 2011 when it was called Pallavaram Return Singing Group; and (below) now as Tambaram Local Singing Group. The music ends every day at Chennai Beach. PHOTOS: A.MURALIDHARAN AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

mil and occasional Hindi songs) wriggled into the centre stage. Now, there is a mix with film songs in a predominant position. However, every singing session is ushered in with a devotional song.

S. Harishankar, whose daily commute transports him to the Secretariat where he is in a team that takes care of all matters pertaining to the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, the premises and the processes, has been a long-time member. He has reasons to view this compartment as a relief, even an escape from the mundane and persistent burdens of life. And also as a space for companionship.

When it burst on the scene, the group was composed of friends, ten of them. And the number stands at around 30, a clutch of them (three to four) trained for professional stage singing. The thirty does not account for the silent participants, seemingly distant but engrossed in the proceedings.

In fact, the fandom of this group, nicknamed

"The Train Friends", stretches across tracks. I. Jayaseelan, an advocate with the Madras High Court who is part of the singing group on the Chennai Central to Tiruvallur suburban line, detains from his regular commute to board this train just for the singing.

Besides the camaraderie among members, which is extended to counterparts from singing groups on other suburban locals such as Jayaseelan, there is respect for fellow passengers, even those frowning at the "concert". Balachandran explains: "Occasionally, when the singing group receives a negative response, even if one passenger objects to the singing, saying it prevents them from having a quiet journey, we immediately stop singing." It takes courage to pursue one's passion, and social consciousness to keep it tempered. This group has evidently got this two-sided equation uncannily right.

'Yoga Parks' to come up at two iconic institutions in Chennai

Under an Ayush initiative, Regional Research Institute of Unani Medicine in Royapuram and National Institute of Siddha in Tambaram are clearing the decks for the establishment of spaces that promote yoga



PHOTO SANDEEP SAXENA

LIFFYTHOMAS

Two institutions from Chennai – National Institute of Siddha in Tambaram and Regional Research Institute of Unani Medicine in Royapuram – figure among the list of spaces in various that are to be promoted as Yoga Parks.

An initiative of the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, Yoga Park Portal encourages corporates, resident welfare associations and other like-minded groups to promote these spaces for wellness programmes.

As on the date, the portal has more than 60 parks across cities registered with them with four being from Tamil Nadu.

A 'Yoga Park' would serve as a dedicated space developed within existing 'parks' in both rural and urban areas, with support from Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives of companies.

These parks are designed to provide a structured, accessible, and inclusive environment for the regular practice of yoga and wellness activities, says a note on the website. The initiative aims to promote healthy lifestyles, community participation, and preventive healthcare by offering nearby residents a serene and well-equipped space for daily yoga practice and holistic well-being.

On June 21, which is International Day of Yoga, both these institutions will be hosting Yoga Day and other wellness programmes.

The huge space that these institutions have is one reason why they easily qualify to be promoted as Yoga Parks.

National Institute of Siddha, for instance, is spread across 14 acres and runs a medical college along with the hospital. Yoga is offered as a speciality and is also prescribed to patients. The Institute is opening up its campus for corporates to invest in improving its infrastructure. "We have identified an open area roughly measuring 200 sq metre within our campus, which can be promoted for yoga, so we have registered for funding under CSR," says a senior staff with the Institute.

For more details, visit
<https://yoga.ayush.gov.in/yogapark>

‘Big Street Boys’ drive vulture conservation initiative

Led by Raghunath Krishna, the 1986 batch of The Hindu Higher Secondary School in Triplicane is taking a critical message about this bird to school students. On June 18, labels carrying caricatures of vultures were distributed to students of Olcott school in Besant Nagar.

PRINCE FREDERICK

Raghunath Krishna is the flywheel driving an initiative by alumni of The Hindu Higher Secondary School in Triplicane, the 1986 batch of the school, self-christened Big Street Boys. If the christening had happened in 1986 the day after the farewell, they need not tender any explanation to Backstreet Boys (est. 1993). If so, the American pop boy band would owe the boys from Triplicane a clear explanation.

On the topic at hand, Raghunath's felt-tip caricature pen (sometimes, a pencil or a piece of charcoal) scripts what would easily pass off as a “reaching-out, giving-back” story. Trained by Raghunath, that pen has a demonstrated history of coaxing grotesquely attention-grabbing images out of the mundane. It is now at the centre of a visual vulture conservation project for school students.

These children would be reminded every day about the bird that is lagging in the numbers game. Raghunath has designed labels to be pasted on school notebooks, and these carry caricatured representations of vultures, portraying them not as carrion-devouring toughies, but cute and cuddle-worthy pets. The facts can be fed to the children later, get their attention first; that thinking is evidently at play.

He observes that his caricature pen is swayed by two philosophies: draw with the a symbol of the target group pinned in the tack board in front of you; and two, no design that ever was effective was put the viewer to sleep, overpowering them with ennui. Hence no posters larded with data, just plain carica-



tures; info posters are necessary, but work only on the follow-up trail. Raghunath's lessons on caricaturing animals for conservation can be viewed at his YouTube Channel, Pencils Rock Academy.

On June 18, the alumni group distributed a huge set of these labels to students of Olcott school at

Besant Nagar and Raghunath spoke about why the vulture's place in the ecosystem cannot be filled by any other creature. Any discussion about vulture is loud on biomagnification: how man-made chemical toxins enter the food chain and affect vultures as they pick at carrion.

Raghunath Krishna; and at a session at Olcott school in Besant Nagar.
PHOTOS: S.R. RAGHUNATHAN AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



This resources to create the labels were generated by the alumni group, members chipping in with contributions. Raghunath points out he would want the initiative to be extended to other schools including his alma mater, The Hindu Higher Secondary School, and that would depend on whether help beyond the batch is forthcoming.

This is not the first time Raghunath is interacting with students on the subject of species conservation. He is a brand strategist working with environment and nature conservation NGOs and creates awareness about the subject among communities living in the creases between wildlife sanctuaries, par-

ticularly the younger generations in their midst. He has done this work among forest-based communities in Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Karnataka.

Among his other significant campaigns are the one on tiger reserves and another on elephants. Titled Elephany, the latter (an art project for children executed during the pandemic) celebrated jumbos, creatures seemingly breathed into life just for the felt-tip caricature pen.

Says Raghunath: “Every elephant is a gardener par excellence. In its lifetime, one without any major twists, an elephant will plant 18 lakh trees/ plants, spreading seeds through its dung.”

Sunday satsang

Sri Krishna Sweets and Sri Vittal Rukmani Samasthanam, Govindapuram are jointly organising Pravah with SRJI - Sunday Satsang programme at Kapaleeswarar Temple, Mylapore, 6.15 p.m. on June 21. This programme will be presented by Srinathdass Maharaj, S/o Vittaldas Maharaj, Govindapuram.

Value education programme

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness has launched a weekly value education programme for children and teens, designed to nurture spiritual and moral values through fun-filled sessions. The programme runs from mid-June to March, with one weekly session lasting between 1.5 and 2

hours. This is offered online and offline across the city, with English or Tamil as the medium of instruction.

Centered around the theme 'Dashavatar', the programme talks about Indian culture. Children (ages 6-12) will enjoy fun-filled learning through stories, quizzes, shlokas, bhajans, fire-

less cooking, and arts and crafts.

Teens (ages 13-17) will be engaged in stimulating, theme-based activities, including debates, group discussions, mind mapping, and Just A Minute sessions.

For registration, visit <https://bpss.fun/bpss-annual-program/>. For further inquiries, call 8072599295.

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Teen with multiple disabilities shines at swimming championship



Diagnosed with Intellectual Disability, Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD), ADHD and speech delay, 13-year-old S. Ishaan delivered a standout performance at the National 26th junior and sub-junior para swimming championships held in Bengaluru recently, bringing pride to Tamil Nadu and inspiration to countless families.

Ishaan, a resident of Koyambedu, delivered a clean sweep across three events (100m butterfly, 100m backstroke, 200m individual medley) displaying an extraordinary

performance that contributed to Tamil Nadu finishing overall runner-up with 52 medals and 182 points. His national triumph came on the heels of another remarkable achievement. Just weeks earlier, on May 18, 2026, Ishaan had claimed three gold medals at the State Paralympics held in Salem. His achievement has been due to years of therapy, disciplined training and an unrelenting support system.

Academy bags 21 medals
SDAT Dolphin Swimming Academy in Mogappair bagged a total of 21



S. Ishaan, a resident of Koyambedu, bagged medals in three events

medals at the 80th Senior State aquatics Championships, organised by the Tamil Nadu State Aquatic Association, recently at SRM University, Kattankulathur. Students from the academy won six golds, nine silver and six bronze medals. In the girls' section, P. Preshitha won gold in the 50m breaststroke and silver in the 100m breaststroke. In the boys' section, M.S. Yadesh Babu clinched three individual silver medals in the breaststroke (50m and 100m), freestyle (50m).

MSN Stars bag SMCA trophy
Rakesh Parthas's fine 81 enabled MSN Stars clinch the 41st SMCA Champions Trophy cricket tournament held at Nelson Wahe Guru Cricket Ground, Kandigai, near Vandalur, with a 33-run win over MSN Lions.

The scores
Final: MSN Stars 228/6 in 30 overs (Md Asif Gr 32, A. S. Santhosh 78, Rakesh Parthas 81) bt MSN Lions 195 in 28.4 overs (Asif Ahmed 34, N. V. Chirag 27, Ajith Wala 28, Mari Appan 66, G. Inbanathan 3/35, V. Sachin 3/43, Kishore Kumar 3/26).
Semifinals: Sachin Cricket Foundation 127/7 in 27 overs (C. Dhilipan 31, Pravin Thy 33) lost to MSN Lions 128/4 in 18.5 overs (M. Sridhar Raj 48, R. Karthikeyan 32).
MSN Stars 171 in 29.2 overs (A. S. Santhosh 46, Mohammed Ashif 25, N. Dinakar 3/22) bt Mighty Warriors 129 in 28.3 overs (Arunachalam 34, Ashuthosh Yadav 3/32).

S. Ishaan; the team from SDAT Dolphin Swimming Academy; and MSN Stars.

Investiture ceremony held



The Seth P D Hinduja Sindhi Model Senior Secondary School recently held the 'Investiture Ceremony' for the 2026-2027 academic year.

S. Manimekalai, Assistant Commissioner of Police, Kilpauk Range, was the chief guest.

The ceremony began with a welcome address by the school principal, Victoria D, who highlighted the core values of leadership, discipline,

and responsibility.

A spirited march past by the newly elected student council captivated the audience.

The council members pledged their commitment to upholding their responsibilities, said a release.

In her address, Manimekalai urged students to embrace discipline, persevere through challenges, and dedicate themselves to serving society.

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Ticket booking time reduced to 5 seconds in CUMTA's app



The Chennai One App of Chennai Unified Metropolitan Transport Authority has introduced a new feature called "One Click Payment: CUMTA UPI." According to a press release, the feature reduces the ticket booking time

from 60 seconds to five seconds. Also, commuters can avail this facility to get the first ticket for ₹1.

CUMTA encourages the public to use this facility to travel seamlessly using the Chennai One App, adds the press release.

Thirukkural competition in August

Shriram Ilakkiya Kazhagam, the literary wing of Shriram Group, is conducting its annual State-level Thirukkural competition on August 29 and 30 at CSI Jessie Moses Matriculation Higher Secondary School in Anna Nagar and at Vels Vidyashram in Pallavaram respectively. It is meant for school, college (including post graduation) and polytechnic students.

According to a press release, the events include: elocution, drawing and painting, and essay writing.

Those interested to take part can collect the application forms from the branches of Shriram Chits or download from www.shriramchits.com

Shriram Ilakkiya Kazhagam has been conduct-



ing this competition every year since 1988 with the aim of inculcating the values and teachings of Thirukkural among youngsters.

Job fair on July 11 at Loyola College



The Rise & Give Life Foundation is organising a job fair on July 11 at Loyola College.

According to a press release, around 500 companies will take part. This includes companies from manufacturing sector, banking and finance, IT and ITES, healthcare, pharmaceutical, education, logistics, tourism, and retail. No fee will be charged for pre-registered candidates but a fee of ₹100 will be charged from those who attend without prior registration, adds the press release.

To register visit, www.givelifes.com or call 75300 88293.

Pattabiram college observes National Reading Day



The Department of Library, in association with the Departments of Tamil and English, celebrated National Reading Day 2026 at DRBCCC Hindu College in Pattabiram.

Titled "Pages of Possibilities," the programme commemorated P.N. Panicker, the Father of India's Library Movement, says a press release.

In his address, N. Rajendra Naidu, the college director, underscored the importance of reading. Also, students presented reviews of their favourite books.

On the occasion, 1,000 copies of *The Hindu* newspaper were distributed to first-year students, adds the press release.

HCL Foundation invites applications for grant

HCL Foundation, the corporate social responsibility wing of HCL Tech - India has announced Edition XII of HCL Tech Grant. According to a press release, it is a grant which will be provided to non-governmental organisations working in the realm of environment, health, and education in rural India.

As part of the project, the foundation has allocated ₹24 crore as grant, adds the press release. The last date for submitting applications is June 30, 2026.

Applications can be downloaded from www.hclfoundation.org/hcltech-grant.

The NGOs will be selected by a jury, adds the press release

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